

LCSW LAW AND ETHICS EXAMINATION

Resources and Sample Questions

LCSW LAW AND ETHICS EXAM RESOURCES

Board of Behavioral Sciences Statutes and Regulations Relating to the Practice of Professional Clinical Counseling, Marriage and Family Therapy, Educational Psychology, and Clinical Social Work.

<https://www.bbs.ca.gov/pdf/publications/lawsregs.pdf>

National Association of Social Workers (NASW) Code of Ethics.

<https://www.socialworkers.org/About/Ethics/Code-of-Ethics/Code-of-Ethics-English>

LCSW LAW AND ETHICS EXAM SAMPLE QUESTIONS

Correct answers are in bold text.

Sample Question 1

A client initiates treatment after the recent death of their spouse. The LCSW's mother also recently died. As the client describes their feelings of loss, the LCSW's own grief is triggered. The LCSW finds it difficult to remain focused on the client during sessions. Which of the following actions should the LCSW take to manage the ethical obligation in this case?

- A. Disclose personal loss to strengthen the therapeutic bond
- B. Explain the personal conflict and refer the client to another therapist
- C. **Consult with a colleague to address the impact of personal feelings on the therapeutic process**
- D. Discuss the importance of boundaries and refrain from discussing issues that evoke personal reactions

Sample Question 2

A client initiates treatment with an LCSW and discloses that they had a sexual relationship with a former therapist. The relationship occurred 4 years after therapy terminated. The client states that they entered the relationship willingly, and that the relationship ended amicably. Which of the following actions should the LCSW take to address the legal obligation in this case?

- A. **Maintain confidentiality and give client the booklet Therapy Never Includes Sexual Behavior**
- B. Maintain confidentiality and encourage the client to press charges against the former therapist
- C. Break confidentiality and confront the former therapist about the unethical behavior
- D. Break confidentiality and file a complaint of professional misconduct with the licensing board

Sample Question 3

A client dislikes the medication he has been prescribed for his depression. The client asks the LCSW for an opinion about an alternative. Which of the following actions should the LCSW take to address the legal obligation in this case?

- A. **Remain within scope of practice and refer the client back to his physician**
- B. Educate the client about psychotropics and encourage medication compliance
- C. Discuss the risks and benefits of the client's medication and suggest a possible alternative
- D. Obtain a release to consult with the client's physician and advocate for a change of medication